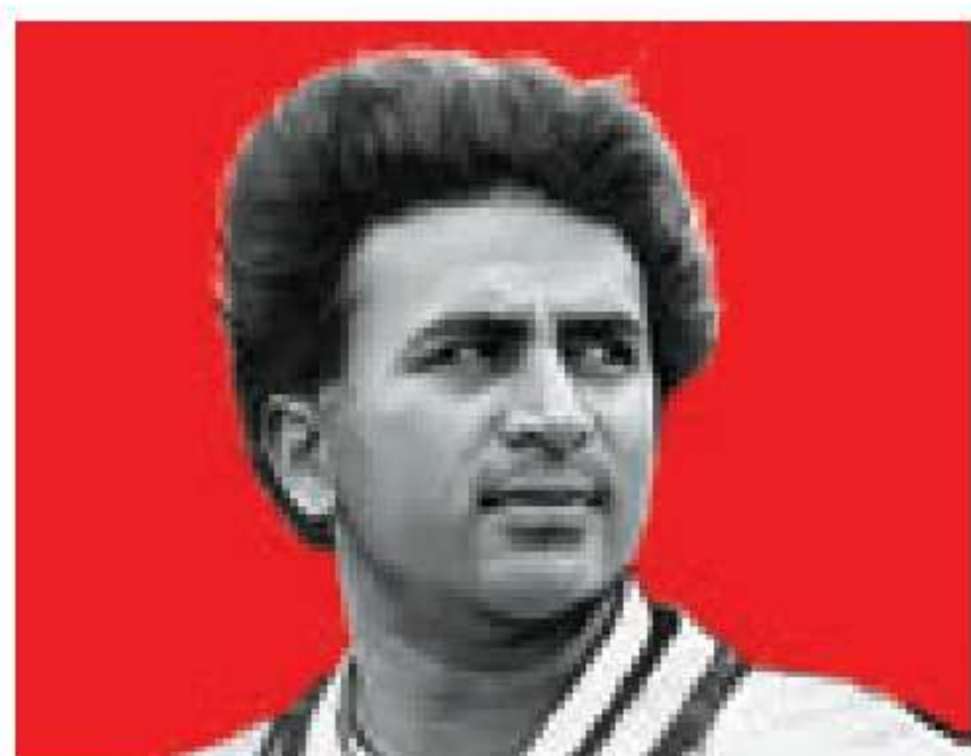




ON THE WRITE LINE

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ALL QUESTIONS ABOUT ROHIT SHARMA'S PLACE IN THE TEAM HAVE BEEN HIT FOR A MASSIVE SIX

There are only a **couple of loose ends** to be tied up, and that is Jasprit Bumrah's availability for the Champions Trophy and Virat Kohli getting back among the hundreds.

The Indian skipper, Rohit Sharma, hitting a sparkling century was perhaps even more reason for celebration than India winning the match and, with it, another one-day series against England. Cricket is a team game, but it's also important, especially ahead of a world tournament like the ICC Champions Trophy, for the lead actors to show that they are in good form and raring to go.

Rohit is perhaps the most destructive opening batter in the one-day game, and his striking form is a vital ingredient if India are hoping to regain the Trophy that they won way back in 2013. Not many batters have hit multiple double-hundreds in this format, and Rohit is one of those rare batters who has done so. It is also crucial for the captain to be in form because he can make good decisions while under pressure. Tough situations require

bold calls, and if a captain is doing well personally, he is not thinking of the ramifications of a bold tactical move going wrong. The move works because when a captain is in great touch, the gut feel, which is an important part of taking the decision, turns right more often than not.

Look at Suryakumar Yadav's calls last year in Sri Lanka while he was captaining the team. When the Lankans were cruising to a win, he brought on Rinku Singh and himself, and both picked wickets and won the game for India. Both hardly ever bowl when they are playing under other captains, but SKY, with his flair for doing the unusual with the bat, also brought out that aspect in his tactical approach since he was full of confidence, and it worked.

In a competition like the Champions Trophy, where only the top ICC-ranked teams participate, there is less likelihood of an easy